Linkages between Brand Personality and Brand Loyalty: A Qualitative Study in an Emerging Market in the Indian Context

Ramesh Kumar, Amit Luthra** and Gaurav Datta****

There are two topical areas, which are of interest to marketers – brand personality and brand loyalty. Brand associations/brand personality and brand loyalty may be associated with one another and may have important implications for marketers. There is a gap in the literature on how each relates to the other and this study attempts to linkages between the two in both consumable and durable categories. The study uses a focus group among the buyers of toothpastes and cars, and suggests a framework linking brand loyalty and brand personality after qualitatively analyzing the responses obtained from the focus group. This would enable marketers in an emerging market like India to formulate brand appeals and branding strategies for different kinds of consumers.

The Indian context, which is the focus of this research study is undergoing radial changes. A population of 1.2 billion people offers complex challenges to marketers. There are multinational brands which are attempting to use the equity of their brands to appeal to a small niche of consumers; here are a millions of masses who buy offerings in the unorganized sector (essentially offerings which are much cheaper than the branded offerings but which may not be strong on quality); there are successful regional brands which have offered the right value taking into account the changing environment and consumer needs. The geographical and cultural spread of the country too poses unique marketing changes. There are 25 states with each one of them having their cultural differences. Companies of fast moving consumer goods have been running discount offers as a part of their strategy. There are also brands, which

* Professor of Marketing, Indian Institute of Management, Bangalore, India. E-mail: rkumar@iimb.ernet.in
** TAS Officer, Tata Administrative Services (TAS), India. E-mail: amitl01@yahoo.com
*** Area Sales Manager, Hindustan Lever Ltd, India. E-mail: goner_in@yahoo.com

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make an attempt to appeal to consumers by creating brand personality strategies. The study is attempted with context specificity as one of the important considerations to enable marketing practitioners to gain a few insights.

LITERATURE REVIEW

A brand has a personality with which acquires a character. The easiest way to bestow personality on a brand is to provide it with a spokesperson, a star, or an animal (Kapferer, 1992). People associate personalities with inanimate objects too on the basis of their opinions and evaluation of the same. It is personality of the brand that provides depth, feelings and liking to the above relationship. Thus, brand personality is an important brand strategy, which marketers use to target consumers and to build relationships with them (Aaker, 1996). As noted by a researcher (Gonzales, 2002), successful brands look beyond building "transactional loyalty" and seek to develop "emotional loyalty". Even in the durable product categories, emotion may be important in consumer decision-making (Amitava, 2002). A brand like Harley Davidson has developed 'brand personality' as a key strategy for competitive differentiation and building loyalty. The influence of the consumer's personality dimensions on the personality of their most preferred brand is another research dimension (Phau and Cheen, 2002). Their concept of self-congruity suggests that consumers tend to choose situations and companions that reaffirm their self-schema. Following from the self-congruity concept, it can be seen that consumers will use a self-congruent brand as a vehicle to express their self-identity. Phau and Cheen also observe that consumers are found to be cross-culturally different both in their preference for products and in their behavior towards brands. The extent of individualism or collectivism in a consumer's culture can be a major determinant in their brand preference, brand association and their self-expression through a brand.

'Relationship Marketing' can be defined as attracting, maintaining and—in multiservice organizations—enhancing customer relationships. The definition relationship management, as an ongoing process of engaging in cooperative and collaborative activities and programs with immediate and end-user customers to create or enhance mutual economic value at reduced cost (Sheth and Paravtiyar, 2000), is a more practice-oriented one. 'Relationship Marketing' can be practiced on the following three levels. The first level deals with the financial incentives to customers; the second level deals with social bonds (like sense of belongingness) and the third level relies on structural aspects to solve complex problems of consumers. There could be degrees of relationships which marketers should take into consideration (Kumar, 2002).

For decades now building brand loyalty has been propounded as the panacea for all organizations to combat the increasing competition in the market place. Various studies have been carried out to understand what constitutes loyalty towards a brand. Early researchers focused on repurchase behavior as a measure of loyalty towards a brand. This singular focus on repeat buy as the only indicator of customer loyalty towards a brand meant that it was assumed that big brands in terms of market share were the

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ones that had the most brand loyal customers. This created the "Double Jeopardy" (Sweetney and Geoffery, 2001) phenomenon for smaller brands, i.e., not only do they have fewer users but their users buy/use them less frequently. In recent times, researchers have also questioned this assumption by pointing out that this approach confuses the "numbers of a brand's devotees with the degree of their devotion to it" (Feldwick, 1996). This approach only leads to the conclusion that the big brands will continue to remain big with no hope for smaller brands to ever capture greater market shares. Alternative approaches of looking at brand loyalty have been suggested in the literature. In recent times, researchers have focused on analyzing and comprehending another dimension of brand loyalty, viz., attitudinal loyalty (Reinartz and Kumar, 2002). Further researches are being carried out on understanding attitudinal loyalty. Some researchers also opine that brand loyalty specific measures are a better reflected through the evaluation of attitudinal loyalty (Bennett and Thiele, 2001). On the other hand, there are theories like polygamous loyalty theory (Dowling and Uncles, 1997), which states that customers do not buy only one brand. They have different propensities to buy different brands. It is a better explanation of consumer behavior than brand switching, which is a "conscious once and for all" change of allegiance to another brand. The widespread belief is that loyal consumers cost less to serve and show lesser sensitivity to price. They purchase more frequently and in larger quantities and have a positive word of mouth (Fournier and Julie, 1998).The link between customer satisfaction and customer loyalty has also been established. Completely satisfied customers are strongly loyal customers (Jones and Earl, 1995). Studies have also been carried out to identify intergenerational influences for products and brands to measure the extent of transfer of brand equity and brand loyalty from one generation to another (Elizabeth, William and Richard, 2002). These studies conclude the following findings; intergenerational impacts are at work across a spectrum of consumer behavior, intergenerational impacts can be measured at different stages of the consumer decision process, intergenerational influences exist within a tumultuous, differentiated market place and not all brands within a product category are equally likely to benefit from intergenerational influences. The need for 'smarter' loyalty building programs and management of loyalty was recently published (Reinartz and V Kumar, 2002). Studies have also been carried out to look at the impact of the different incentives offered in loyalty programs. Michelle Bolman and Roehm Jr., (2002) have found that more the incentive is compatible with the brand and the less tangible it is, greater is the likelihood of leading to loyalty rather than drawing attention to itself. Halberg (1995) voiced the opinion backed up by studies that all consumers are not created equal. In tune with several practices of the past it was felt that retaining heavy users of a brand is critical to brand profitability. This approach gave rise to the concept of segmenting by profitability, which emphasized that, a distinctive set of marketing mix elements would have to be formulated in order to sustain the loyalty of a base of consumers who had reflected commitment to the brand. According to Assel (2001), repeat

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purchase based on reasons other than commitment to a brand is inertia loyalty. Therefore any research on loyalty should take inertia loyalty into consideration. While loyalty, satisfaction and Customer Relationship Management (CRM) are related concepts, recent literature throws up several interesting findings, which may be of importance to consumers. One such finding is that satisfaction need not contribute to loyalty (Reichheld, 2002). Another finding is that online consumers (Reichheld and Phil, 2000) spend more if they are loyal to the vendor for a fixed period of time, which varies from one product category to another. Amazon.com is a very good example of how the online retailer is able to sustain loyal consumers. 60-70% of purchases made by consumers are repeat purchases. The recent linkages with regard to customer loyalty have been the various factors which lead to customer migration Gokey and Harold (2002) published that there could be different kinds of loyalists who migrate to other brands for various kinds of reasons and there could also be downward customer migration (customers who opt for offerings at a lower price point because of dissatisfaction with a product or service or for other reasons). Given the complexities of managing loyalty, a firm may have to cultivate several kinds of relationships over a period of time among its customer base. The complexities could involve the brand's share of customer requirements (given a customer's total requirement with regard to a product category) and the intention to buy (Kumar, 2002). This approach, which could be, applied both to FMCG products and industrial consumables would require companies to research several aspects of customer satisfaction and brand loyalty. This approach combines several aspects of loyalty, customer satisfaction, inertia loyalty and switching behavior of consumers. Recency (how recently a customer has bought a brand), frequency (frequency of purchase of a brand) and value (the monetary value of the purchase) known as RFM, is regarded as a good measure of customer loyalty.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

The study attempted the following:

To explore the role of brand personality and value in creating brand loyalty in the following two product categories

- Durable—Passenger Cars
- Consumables—Tooth-pastes

The following dimensions were addressed in the study:

- To explore the linkages between brand personality and brand loyalty.
- To suggest strategies with regard to brand personality and brand loyalty which could be applied by marketers.

METHODOLOGY

The study attempted to explore personality-loyalty linkages in with regard to one consumable and one durable category to cover both high involvement and low involvement purchase categories.

The choice of the product categories was made keeping in mind the following:

1. The categories should be an established one where consumer tastes and preferences are established and not evolving (like for a new product) so that behavioral patterns can be studied.
2. The categories should have enough brands so that the customer has options if she wants to use them.

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3. Switching costs should not be too high so that loyalty is not forced upon the customers.
4. The consumable category should have a small purchase cycle and high purchase frequency.

The following product categories were selected to carry out focused research.

- Consumables—Toothpaste
- Durable Category—Passenger Cars

Selection of Brands

It was decided to study closely a few brands in the chosen categories to understand the positioning-personality frameworks currently being applied.

- Toothpaste—Close Up
- Cars—Santro
- The choice of the brands was influenced by the following reasons:

1. The brands should have a very distinctive and clearly communicated personality/associations (either functional or symbolic or both).
2. The brands should have clearly defined value-creating attributes, which is likely to have an impact on brand loyalty.

The category of toothpaste was selected as it was a familiar category among consumers and they buy the category often. Toothpaste is also a category, which has been widely advertised for the last two decades and there was a high probability that consumers may have formed a brand association with specific brands. Close Up, Pepsodent and Colgate were considered as these brands have been actively attempting to create strong associations with their brand building efforts in the recent times. Colgate was dropped as it had too many variants and it was felt that consumers may be confused with regard to these associations. For the same reason, the study was restricted to one brand from consumable category and one from durable category. The objective was to study and explore the linkages between brand personality and brand loyalty (and not brand associations). Close up was selected, as it was a strong brand among youth and has been in the market for more than 25 years, advertised widely throughout its presence in the Indian market and perhaps, the first brand to create strong association among youth in the category of toothpastes. Santro, in consumer durable category, was selected because it was the fastest growing brand in the respective segment in terms of market share, advertised initially with a clear functional association (with a variety of features and the tall boy design) and advertised later on lifestyle associations (as the sunshine car with celebrities). The other car considered in the respective segment was Palio and the brand did not match Santro on the criterion with which the car brand was selected for the study.

Sample Selection

The profile of the target group of customers selected for the study is as follows

- Cars:
  - Demographics
    - i. Age: 25-40 years.
    - ii. Gender: Mostly males.
    - iii. Income: Monthly household. income of Rs. 25,000-40,000, upper middle class.
    - iv. Education: At least a graduation degree.
- Toothpastes
  - Demographics
    - i. Age: 20-40 years. Though Close Up is a youth brand it

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was decided to include some respondents above 25 years as the brand has been in the Indian market for the last 25 years.

ii. Gender: Males and Females.

iii. Income: Monthly household income of Rs. 25,000-40,000, upper middle class .

iv. Education: Graduation degree.

It was felt that focus group method would enable the respondents to share their insights and produce data which would be less accessible without group interaction given the nature of this study (Lindlof, 1995). As the study involved personality traits as applied to brands, it was felt that a focus group would also foster a freer expression of such (Levy, 1999). Qualitative focus group research was conducted among respondents in both categories (one group of eight respondents were used for each category) on various aspects of loyalty and brand personality. These aspects were choice of the brand, vanity, materialism, innovative-ness, social character, epistemic variables, extended self, consumer ethnocentrism, loyalty, emotional influences, performance, quality and cognitive factors. The research findings were qualitatively analyzed and a framework linking brand personality and brand loyalty was developed.

ANALYSIS OF FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION

DISCUSSION ON CARS

The various aspects, researched in the study with regard to cars have been showed individually to give an idea to the reader, about the extent to which they have been associated with the response of the respondents.

1. **Cognitive Factors**
   Product related information was primary concern of everyone in the group when they evaluated ads. They felt that print ads were more helpful in decision-making.
2. **Brand Personification**
   They felt that it was just an attempt by marketers to differentiate the brand by associating a celebrity like Sharukh Khan or Sachin Tendulkar to a car. The brand ambassadors do not influence them; they can at best be attention-catching devices. A car was a car for them.
3. **Quality**
   Quality of the car was associated with maintenance (after features and performance) and it was an important consideration for everyone in the group. The number of service stations and spare parts availability were found to be important.
4. **Performance**
   This was critical for everyone, but there were divergent views on what constituted performance for them. Each one had different criteria, varying from mileage to maneuverability.
5. **Emotional**
   Everyone wanted driving pleasure out of the car but did not attach much emotional value to their cars.
6. **Price**
   Price was the deciding factor to decide on the category but a difference of a few thousands between different models was not important.
7. **Loyalty**
   Everyone said that they would look at all the options available whenever

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they were to buy their next car without any bias because of the current car owned.

For those who switched cars, the reasons were,

* Upgrading to better options
* Needed a bigger car
* Trusted the Toyota brand name after the experience abroad. But attitudinal loyalty was exhibited as they all said they would certainly recommend their brands based on the positive experience they have had with their cars.

8. **Choice of Brand**

The choice of the segment was price dependent while the choice of the brand was features dependent. Only two respondents had bought more than one car in India, and two other had bought cars abroad. For the rest four it was their first car.

9. **Materialism**

All the respondents felt that material possessions were not important to their lives. Specifically on cars, the opinion was that it was a utilitarian vehicle.

10. **Innovativeness**

There was no one in the group who was passionate about cars. They felt that they were too busy juggling careers to keep up with the category developments. All of them said that before buying a car they would like to go through the performance reviews, as it was a substantial investment.

11. **Consumer Ethnocentrism**

Country of origin was not a concern at all for all but one respondent. This respondent also had changed his view after his experience with an indigenous car.

12. **Extended Self**

For all the respondents, car was not an extension of self. They did not feel that the car was a reflection of self. The whole idea of a car representing what they are seemed preposterous to them.

13. **Vanity**

For most the looks of the car were not crucial as it was just utilitarian vehicle. But when probed further five of them did submit that the looks of the car where certainly more important than other products like clothes as this is a more long-term investment. For this 50% car was also a status symbol to some extent.

14. **Social Character**

Only opinions of a few close friends mattered and the general opinion of peers were not considered. It was their car, hence they made the decision.

15. **Epistemic Variables**

All the respondents test-drove all the available models in the price category. But the final decision was not made with the view to stand out from the crowd.

Key Findings from the Responses

Cars are a very high involvement category, and hence, decisions are made after much deliberation. Prospective buyers test all available models and the purchase decision is primarily made on the basis of a methodical comparison of features. While car was an important investment, its value in the lives of the respondents was not too much and very little emotions

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were attached to it. Car was mainly looked at as a utilitarian vehicle with elements of vanity and social acceptance associated with the brand being somewhat relevant. The advertisements that use brand ambassadors were just attention grabbing mechanisms and played no part in the actual decision-making process, which was a cold, methodical one. This may conflict with the earlier finding that vanity and social acceptance related to the brand does surface in decision-making. Print ads focusing on the features were more of interest. Hence, the influencing role played by the brand personality of a car is very limited.

Attitudinal Loyalty was exhibited as the respondents would recommend their brands based on their experience but behavioral loyalty was unlikely, as they said they would consider all options available without a bias whenever they would make their next purchase. Changing or improving a brand's personality did not change the way the respondents thought of their car, and hence, did not influence loyalty towards the brand.

Discussion on Toothpaste Category

As in the case of cars the responses from respondents on the category of toothpaste is given below:

1. **Choice of Brand**

   Current toothpastes used: Close Up, Colgate Gel, Colgate Dental Cream, Pepsodent. Only three umbrella brands were present in the choice set of all the respondents. 50% of the panel used more than one brand. Though the respondents had tried variants of their favorite brand but most of them reverted back of the original brand.

2. **Materialism**

   All the respondents felt that material possessions were not important to their lives.

3. **Innovativeness**

   Though the involvement towards a subcategory (such as gel toothpastes) was high, but the category of toothpastes on the whole enjoyed moderate involvement.

4. **Consumer Ethnocentrism**

   Could not be explored satisfactorily.

5. **Compulsive Buying**

   All the respondents said they never indulge in compulsive purchase of toothpastes. Mostly they know what brand to buy before they enter the shop and don't get tempted into impulse purchase.

6. **Extended Self**

   For all the respondents toothpaste was not an extension of self. But they did feel that at times toothpaste was a reflection of the self. They think that they feel younger, more enthusiastic and spirited if they use gel toothpaste.

7. **Vanity**

   The looks of the toothpaste were important to 100% of the panel. They believe that their toothpaste reinforced their good looks and helped them feel good about themselves.

8. **Social Character**

   The opinion of peers and even close friends was not considered at all in the purchase decision.

9. **Epistemic Variables**

   Sometimes the epistemic variables caused a temporary brand switch. But the novelty of the new brand did not last for very long.

10. **Cognitive Factors**

    High recall of the advertisements was

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noticed. Though certain information such as the new chemicals such a germi-check or micro-granules did affect the decision, it was the symbolism that played a greater role in their decision.

11. Brand Personification

Strong personality associated with for two brands, Close Up and Pepsodent. Perhaps, this may be because of the clearly communicated personality of these brands in the promotions.

12. Quality

There were no clear determinants of quality apart from product attributes such as freshness and the parent company of the brand.

13. Performance

Freshness was the single most important variable of judging performance. Though white teeth and strong teeth were the others, but they did not seem as important because they are more difficult to evaluate.

14. Emotional

High emotional connotation because of the favorable effect on looks.

15. Price

Value plays an important role in the purchase decision. Price itself is not a strong determinant, but price/quality relationship is what drives the decision to buy. The price difference between brands was considered to be minimal. So it did not affect the choice much.

16. Loyalty

The loyalty towards the subcategory (such as gel) is seen to be much higher than onwards the brands itself. All the respondents said they would prefer not to switch from their current brand. If their brand is unavailable in the shop then they will prefer to buy a different size or go to another shop. Intergenerational loyalty is high and the intent to repurchase the same brand is also very high.

Key Findings from the Responses

Brand personality and value both played a role in determining brand and category loyalty of the consumers. Brand personality was seen to play a much more significant role. Brands with a clearly communicated consistent personality had a bigger set of loyal customers. This was due to the inability of the buyers to differentiate the interface between personality and value. Brand personality reinforced certain value dimensions such as emotional value, epistemic value and situational value. Value was also found difficult to determine as the respondents could not express much about of the quality variables and the price is not much of a differentiator between brands. Thus communication for a low involvement product category such as toothpastes should emphasize brand personality over value. High intergenerational loyalty was seen to be present. Such intergenerational loyalty was seen in brands, which have had a consistent personality over a large period of time. This can also be attributed to usage pattern of a product, like toothpaste that has an essential daily usage by the entire family. Thus the members of the family have a strong influence on one another in determining the choice of brand and subsequent brand loyalty. Loyalty was observed to be greater for a product subcategory such as 'gel' toothpaste than towards the whole toothpaste category in general or a particular brand of toothpaste.

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Promotional efforts in sync with the personality of the brand was seen to have a high recall amongst the respondents. For example, 'The germ-detector' of Pepsodent further strengthened the 'mother-like protective' personality of the brand.

IMPLICATIONS OF THE RESEARCH STUDY

DURABLE PRODUCT CATEGORY

The focus in the car market and for other such durables is clearly on the value proposition, with brand personality playing a marginal role. Thus, marketers of such high involvement products need to focus on developing the right product more than establishing a brand personality. As the purchase decision for these products is mainly made based on a feature comparison, the manufacturers need to ensure that their product has the technological capabilities desired by the target segment. There is a very strong value orientation for purchase of a car and similar products, hence, the marketers need to ensure that the price-feature comparison is in their favor. Cars/Durables marketers must therefore understand what forms the value equation for their product. Marketers need to identify what constitute the value set in a brand and provide an enhanced value set, which is superior to that of competitive brands. Thus, it has to be a value-based differentiation and not just a symbolic differentiation as achieved through brand personality. Brand personality can at best complement the value-based differentiation but cannot substitute it. Building loyalty for such high involvement products is a tough task as loyalty is completely value driven with the brand's personality not playing an important role for an informed set of buyers. They would undertake a thorough analysis of all offerings before every purchase disregarding their previous brand used. Further, in a category like cars when customers buy a second or a third car, they are looking to upgrade, from one price segment to another. Hence, the focus of the marketers should be to establish not loyalty for a particular brand but for the overall marquee, that's the manufacturer's umbrella brand. For example, A Hyundai Santro buyer is unlikely to buy another Hyundai Santro but would like to upgrade to higher value car like a Hyundai Accent. Now the task of Hyundai is established loyalty for Hyundai through Hyundai Santro so that the Santro buyer upgrades to a Hyundai Accent not to a competitive brand. Thus, once the purchase has been made, the marketers must continue to make the buyer of their brand believe that her car offers the best value proposition by delivering on the features, and perhaps on services too, as it would be a rational input for the next cycle of purchase decision while upgrading.

CONSUMABLES PRODUCT CATEGORY

The higher significance of brand personality over value in this product category necessitates that firms should focus on the brand personality construct than value construct in consumable categories that are characterized by low customer involvement. Brand (subcategory) personality should be effectively leveraged to reinforce important value dimensions. For instance the 'youthful-get a life' personality of Close Up emphasizes the emotional value of confidence amongst youngsters. It prompts the target market to feel confident of themselves to interact with the opposite sex. This confidence platform also further strengthens

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situational value of using Close Up before important social gatherings such as parties. Similarly, Pepsodent toothpaste has a "mother-like" effective germ fighter personality. This brand personality reinforces the emotional value of mental peace by reducing the mother-child conflict about what they are allowed to eat. The 24 hour long protection from germs removes a mother's fear and anxiety about germs infecting their kids' teeth whenever they eat thereby increasing their peace of mind and reducing their worries. Such personality congruence has also been used effectively by several other brands in the Indian market. The 'protection through health' positioning of Lifebuoy soap has given it a 'mother-like' personality of care and concern. This personality has been used to reinforce value derived from the brand. One important prerequisite for leveraging the brand personality construct is that the communication should have a clearly differentiated and well-communicated personality consistent over a long period of time. Even when an attempt is made to change the communication of the brand, the original personality and value dimensions should be highlighted to minimize confusion and dissonance amongst the customers.

All further communication and promotion efforts should be in a direction to reinforce the established personality of the brand. There should be high consistency in the promotions in-line with existing value and personality dimensions of the brand. This will help differentiate the brand further in the minds of the consumer. The firms should study the extent to which a brand enjoys intergenerational loyalty amongst its target customers. Intergenerational loyalty can be reinforced by appropriate communication emphasizing how the brand has been effective in delivering its core benefit over the years. The loyalty created will be especially higher if the senior members of the family were early adopters of a new toothpaste concept, such as the gel variant in toothpaste in late 1970s in the Indian market. Such early adopter loyalists can be used as opinion leaders to inculcate loyalty amongst their own family members and other acquaintances. Subcategory loyalty should be used as an important tool to create brand loyalty. This has increased importance in the case of a first mover brand in a new subcategory. The brand should first create loyalty and commitment towards the subcategory and then create an irreplaceable link between the subcategory and the brand. Close Up, the initiator of the gel subcategory in the Indian market, used this construct effectively. It promoted 'gel for freshness' as the toothpaste for the young and then firmly established itself as the only gel toothpaste in the market for a long-time. This approach significantly raises the entry barriers for a new entrant in a highly profitable segment by increasing the switching costs of the loyal customers.

FRAMEWORK ON BRAND PERSONALITY AND BRAND LOYALTY LINKAGES

THE NEED FOR A FRAMEWORK, WHICH INVOLVES BRAND LOYALTY AND BRAND PERSONALITY

The literature clearly establishes the need for performance-related factors and image-related factors, as strong factors are influencing buying behavior. Several dimensions of brand loyalty and brand personality were explored in the literature. In the research study conducted, though

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respondents were had expressed less of emotional/psychological, meaning non-utilitarian factors with regard to purchase of brands in both the consumable category as well as durable category, there were a few important pointers in both these categories, which in the opinion of researchers warrant a framework, that will link brand personality and brand loyalty. In particular, the vanity factor was considered by most respondents in cars, as an important factor to the extent of being even a status symbol.

In toothpastes, vanity, brand personality, extended self and emotional factors were clearly presented in the consideration behavior of respondents. Another important consideration with regard to implications to marketers is that, both brand loyalty and brand personality have a long-term orientation, and hence, they have to involve a judicious management of marketing mix elements. This necessitates a framework involving both brand loyalty and brand personality with a marketing mix interface. Finally, there is little academic literature, which offers a framework with brand loyalty and brand personality linkages. Hence there is a clear need for a framework which establishes linkages between brand loyalty and brand personality, making marketing mix elements instrumental in the outcome related to these factors. This study too establishes the importance of such a framework Figure-1 for practitioners of marketing.

The Personality-Loyalty framework consists of brand loyalty and brand personality associations, and both these factors are categorized as 'low', and 'high'. The combination results in four types of consumers. A brand should find out what percentage of consumers are present in each of these combinations and if there is a dominant presence of consumers in any of the quadrants. This classification would be useful for the marketers to formulate marketing mix strategies.

- **The Hard Core Group:** These consumers rank the brand high on value and brand personality appeal. If the category is a Fast Moving Consumer Good (FMCG,) the brand should ensure that it builds up a relationship with this kind of consumers. The relationship program should be an exercise, which would enhance the value and the brand personality appeal. A toothpaste brand, which has 'white teeth' as its proposition and a personality appeal of being youthful, outgoing, could have a promotional contest which reinforces the proposition as well as the personality. "Whiteness" of the teeth leading to exciting gifts ranging from group adventure activity to psychological benefits of becoming popular through mass media after taking part in such experiences. In this context (as appropriate to the

Figure 1: Brand Personality-Brand Loyalty Linkages—A Framework

Brand Personality Associations		Brand Loyalty (Value-Based): High	Brand Loyalty (Value-Based): Low
	Low	Prospective Switchers	Quitters
	High	Hard Core	Hunters

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brand), the "whiteness" (value) leads to several social benefits, which are associated with the personality of the brand. Product improvements adding more value-base are applicable to durables.

- **Hunters:** These consumers rank high on brand personality but low on loyalty. In a typical FMCG situation like soaps or cosmetics, the consumers may identify their "inner-self" with the brand but the value provided by the brand may not be adequate for these consumers to remain loyal to the brand. A competing brand could provide value to this group of consumers and over a period of time develop a personality with which consumers get associated themselves. While this is possible both in FMCG categories and durables, durable marketers (in categories like cars, two-wheelers, washing machines, television) may have a greater impact on consumers because of the infrequent purchases made by consumers. LG is a brand, which is into the several categories and the proposition is value-based (fabric care in washing machines, pure-air in air conditioners and nutrition in refrigerators). "Care and trust" is the personality dimension which gets supported by value-based dimensions. Given the low unit value of FMCG products and the opportunity for consumers to switch, a brand is a consumable category may find it feasible to attract a "niche segment" and move them to the previous quadrant. A niche segment would be able to provide a premium, to get associated with an "exclusive brand personality" and have added benefits in terms of value.
- **Prospective Switchers:** Compared to the second quadrant these consumers may take a longer time to switch brands as their loyalty is very high and this is based on their "value experience". These is a high probability that these consumers are more inner-directed, and hence, personality-based brand building dimensions have a low influence in terms of emotional impact. A brand in this situation should not only sustain the "value experience"; it has to also ensure that appropriate positioning strategies are formulated for the inner-directed consumers (if it finds that majority of consumers have this profile). If not the brand has to build appropriate strategies to move the consumers to quadrant 1.
- **Quitters:** In a competitive context it would be difficult for any brand to survive in this quadrant.

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APPENDIX

Dimensions Explored in the Study

The following personality, loyalty and value dimensions were explored using focus groups.

TOOTHPASTES

CHOICE OF BRAND

- Name one brand of toothpaste.
- What's your favorite brand of toothpaste?
- Why do you prefer this brand over others?
- What are the brands you are currently using?
- For how long have you been using this brand of toothpaste?
- What are the other brands you have used?
- Why did you switch to the current brand?
- Would you switch to a new brand in your next purchase? Why or why not?
- How much time do you normally spend while making a purchase decision?
- What is the most important thing to you in your choice of toothpaste while making a purchase?

PERSONALITY SCALE ITEMS

Materialism

- My brand of toothpaste forms an important part of my everyday life.
- I'd rather buy a brand of toothpaste that simply looks better (more appeal) rather than cleaning my teeth better.

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Innovativeness

- I know the names of new toothpastes launched before most other people do.
- In general I am among the first in my circle of friends to try out new brands of toothpastes.
- If I hear that new toothpaste is available in the stores then I surely would be interested in buying it.
- I would like to try a new kind of toothpaste even if I have never used anything like it before. .
- I normally treat new products with caution.
- I seek others' opinion before I try a new product.
- I would be more comfortable trying out a new product that is endorsed by a celebrity than a completely unknown one.
- I buy a product which reinforces my beliefs rather than one which contradicts them.
- While evaluating a new product I pay more attention to product benefits, factual differences and product usage information.

Consumer Ethnocentrism

- Toothpastes made in India, by Indian companies will always be better than the ones produced abroad.
- Even though toothpastes are a foreign innovation, it is a much better product for oral hygiene than traditional remedies.
- A true Indian will always buy Indian products, be it cars or toothpastes.

Compulsive Buying

- I am often impulsive in my buying behavior.
- I have bought things though I couldn't afford them.
- I will go to a store and pick up any brand of toothpaste I see without much thought.
- I have often bought products, like a new brand of toothpaste or a brand on with promotional offer that I did not need, knowing I had very little money left.
- I sometimes buy things just to make myself feel better.

Extended Self

- I trust my toothpaste in taking care of my teeth.
- The model in the ad reflects what I want to be and hence, I use this brand.

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- My toothpaste also symbolizes my identity.
- My toothpaste helps me project the persona I want to present to my friends.
- The toothpaste I use says a lot about the kind of person I am.
- My toothpaste helps me be what I have always wanted to be.
- My toothpaste helps me experience a part of me which I wouldn't have discovered otherwise.

Vanity

- The way I look is extremely important to me.
- My toothpaste helps me look and feel better.
- It is important that I always look good.
- I think strong, shiny white teeth are very important for me to look good.
- My toothpaste makes me look better by ensuring fresh breath.
- People often notice how attractive I am
- People pay attention to the smallest detail about the way I look.
- People often walk up to me and comment on my smile.
- Achieving greater success than my peers is extremely important to me.
- My teeth add to my sex appeal.

Social Character

- I will normally buy a product at my own discretion, nor bothering much about its social acceptability.
- I will never buy a product which does socially unacceptable advertising.
- Social approval is important to me before I buy a product.
- I will stop using my brand of toothpaste if it indulges in sexually explicit, violent or morally unacceptable forms of promotion.
- I decide what is right or wrong for me, and don't let people do that.

Epistemic Variables (variety-novelty seeking)

- I like variety in whatever I buy.
- I will try out a new toothpaste just for the sake of variety.
- Too much variety confuses me.
- Greater variety helps me make a better choice of my product.
- I might try out a new toothpaste for variety sake but not a new car.

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Cognitive Factors

- I pay most attention to the product related information while watching an advertisement for a toothpaste.
- I am more attracted towards the model in the new ad for a toothpaste than the features.
- The features of a toothpaste highlighted in the ad have little effect on my purchase decision.
- I am more enthused by how exciting an ad is than how much information it provides me.
- The music/jingle of the ad stays with me for a while even though I may forget the brand and its features.
- I will base my purchase decision to buy a toothpaste only on how much I know about its benefits and how its different from the others.

Brand Personification

- I like my toothpaste to be high energy, like an athlete.
- I want a toothpaste that excites me.
- My toothpaste is my close friend.
- I want my toothpaste to be reliable.
- I want my toothpaste to be honest and down to earth and effective.
- I believe that a red colored toothpaste cleans better than a white one.
- I believe that a blue toothpaste is fresher than a red one or a white one.

VALUE DIMENSIONS

Quality

- My toothpaste should perform consistently.
- Consistent quality would make me buy the same brand of toothpaste again.
- My toothpaste should taste the same every time I buy a new pack.

Performance

- My toothpaste must protect my teeth for me to ever use it again.
- If I suffer from any Dental problem I will promptly change my brand.
- If my friend told me that my breath does not smell fresh I would go buy a new brand immediately.

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Emotional

- My toothpaste should make me feel good about the day when I use it in the morning.
- My toothpaste should make me look forward to brushing my teeth over and over again.

Price

- My toothpaste should offer me value for money.
- My toothpaste should workout to be economical for me.
- Price should not be a concern for me when I buying the same of brand of car and toothpaste again.
- A promotional offer will not make a difference to my purchase decision.
- I often which brand of toothpaste to buy at the retail counter based on the promotional offers available at that point.
- I don't mind buying an extra toothpaste even though I don't need it currently if it is available on discount.

Social

- My brand must be accepted by friends
- I will not try a brand that my friends have bad mouthed.
- I will think twice before buying a brand that no one in my friend circle uses.
- I decide which brand of toothpaste to use what people think has no bearing on my choice.
- All my toothpaste is supposed to do is to protect my teeth and provide fresh breath; it is not going to help me win a beauty pageant.
- I would rather use a gel toothpaste when I am going for social gathering to gain more confidence.
- Ads showing toothpastes helping people win girlfriends are downright stupid.
- Social acceptability will help me want to buy the same brand again.

Loyalty

- I am most likely to use the same brand of toothpaste for my future needs.
- I will not even search for information on another brand of toothpaste the next time I buy a new toothpaste.
- I have purchased other products from the same company.
- I always suggest and recommend my brand of toothpaste to my friends and colleagues.

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- If my brand of toothpaste is not available at one store then I will go to another store to buy it, but not buy any other brand.
- I rarely take chances by buying unfamiliar brands even if it means sacrificing variety.
- I would rather wait for others to try out a new brand than try it out myself.
- I would rather stick with a brand I usually buy than try something I am not very sure of.
- If I like a brand, I rarely switch from it just to try something different.
- I usually buy the same brands even if they are only average.
- When I enter a store, then I am sure I want to buy only my brand of toothpaste and nothing else.
- I feel proud to be seen buying my brand.
- If I find my brand is not giving me the quality I expect it to, then I switch to another brand.
- After switching from my favorite brand, I never go back to it.
- I always try my favorite brand again even after switching to other brands.
- I am loyal to a brand that is being used in my home for the past many years.
- My parents made me loyal to a few brands they were loyal to.
- My children also have the tendency to use some of the brands they see me using regularly.
- If my favored brand reduces my social acceptability then I switch to other brands.
- If my favored brand no longer offers me value for money then I will switch to another brand.
- I will always buy a brand I can relate to.
- I will be loyal to a brand whose personality matches mine.
- The more the congruence between my personality and that of my favorite brand, the more loyal I will be to it.
- My brand reinforces my personality.
- I reinforce my brands personality in turn.
- I will keep buying the brand which makes me realize what I am.

CARS

CHOICE OF BRAND

- Name one brand of car.
- What's your favorite brand of car?

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- Why do you prefer this brand over others?
- Which car do you own/use?
- For how long have you been using this brand of car?
- What are the other brands you have used?
- Why did you switch to the current brand?
- Would you switch to a new brand in your next purchase? Why or why not?
- What is the most important thing to you in your choice of car?
- How much time do you normally spend while making a purchase decision?

PERSONALITY SCALE ITEMS

Materialism

- The car I own says a lot about how successful I am in life.
- I would rather own a car that would impress other people than serve my needs better.
- I don't place much importance on material things such as cars as indicators of success in life.
- I'd rather spend money on a car that looks and feels good even though it might be impractical.
- I like keeping my life simple, as far as possessions are concerned.
- I would be much more happier if I could afford one more car.
- I am happy to buy a car that satisfies my needs without many frills.

Innovativeness

- I know the names of new cars to be launched before other people do.
- In general I am the among the first in my circle of friends to know about new cars to be launched.
- Compared to people I know, I own fewer cars.
- In general I am among the first in my circle of friends to buy a new car.
- If I am aware that a new car has been launched then I surely will go and test-drive it, to purchase it if I like it.
- I like buying the latest cars which are available and which suit my budget.
- I normally treat new products with caution.
- I seek others' opinion before I try a new product
- I would be more comfortable trying out a new product that is endorsed by a celebrity than a completely unknown one.
- I buy a product which reinforces my beliefs rather than one which contradicts them.

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- While evaluating a new product I pay more attention to product benefits, factual differences and product usage information.

Consumer Ethnocentrism

- I will always buy a car that is made in India by an Indian company.
- People should not be allowed to import cars to India, as they are being manufactured here too.
- Import of foreign cars should be taxed heavily to encourage people to buy Indian made cars.
- I will buy an Indian car even if it is a bit lower in quality than the foreign cars.
- A true Indian will always buy Indian products, be it cars or toothpastes.

Extended Self

- My car holds a very special place in my life.
- My car helps me project a desired image to the world.
- My car is central to my identity.
- I am very emotionally attached to my car
- My car helps reinforce who I am.
- My car helps me narrow the gap between what I am and what I try to be.
- I would be a very different person without my car.

Vanity

- The way I look is extremely important to me.
- My car adds to my good looks.
- It is important that I always look good.
- When I go out to a public place, the car I drive enhances my looks.
- People often notice how attractive I am.
- People pay attention to the smallest detail about the way I look.
- Achieving greater success than my peers is extremely important to me.
- My car is a sign of my success.

Social Character

- I will normally buy a product at my own discretion, nor bothering much about its social acceptability.
- I will never buy a product which does socially unacceptable advertising.
- Social approval is important to me before I buy a product.

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- I will switch cars if my girlfriend disapproved of my current car.
- Car is a status symbol and hence, what my peers think of it is crucial.
- Car is driving and that's all it should do.
- I will stop using my brand of car if it indulges in sexually explicit, violent or morally unacceptable forms of promotion.
- I decide what is right or wrong for me, and don't let people do that.

Epistemic Variables (variety-novelty seeking)

- I like variety in whatever I buy.
- I will try out a new toothpaste just for the sake of variety.
- Too much variety confuses me.
- Greater variety helps me make a better choice of my product.
- I might try out a new toothpaste for variety sake but not a new car.
- If I had the money I would buy a totally different car from what I currently own for variety.

Cognitive Factors

- I pay most attention to the product related information while watching an advertisement for a car.
- I am more attracted towards the model in the new ad for a car than the features.
- I am more enthused by how exciting an ad is than how much information it provides me.
- The music/jingle of the ad stays with me for a while even though I may forget the brand and its features.
- I prefer print ads as they let me glean the relevant technical information.
- I will base my purchase decision to buy a car only on how much I know about its benefits and how its different from the others.
- I would rather have more visual information about a new car than read about it.

Brand Personification

- I like my car to be high energy, like an athlete.
- I would like my brand to be sincere
- I want a car that excites me.
- Sophistication is most important to me (than ruggedness) when I buy a car.
- My car is my close friend.

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- The color of my car is an important decision variable.
- I want my car to be reliable.

VALUE DIMENSIONS

Quality

- My car should have consistent quality.
- My car should be really well made.
- My car should not have poor workmanship.
- My car should last a long-time.
- My car should not demand frequent repairs.
- Good quality car will make me want to buy the same brand the next time.

Emotional

- My car should be one that I enjoy driving.
- My car should be one which makes me want to use it.
- My car should make me feel good.
- My car should make me want to use it.
- Driving my car should give me more than just utilitarian driving comfort.
- Driving my car should be a relaxing experience.
- Driving my car should be an exciting experience.
- Driving my car should make me smile every time I am behind the steering wheel.
- More the emotional satisfaction I derive from my driving experience, more loyal I will be towards my brand.

Price

- My car should be reasonably priced.
- My car should be a good product for the price.
- The features offered should be directly proportional to the price charged.
- The features offered should form the primary basis of price charged
- I should feel that I have paid the right price for my car
- Price should not be a concern for me when I buying the same of brand of car again.

Social

- My car would help me to feel socially acceptable.

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- My car would improve the way I am perceived.
- My car would make a good impression on the other people.
- My car will give me social approval.
- Social acceptability will help me want to buy the same brand again.

Loyalty

- When I purchased my car this brand was my first choice.
- I will not even search for information on another brand of cars the next time I buy a new car.
- I have purchased other products from the same company.
- I always suggest and recommend my brand of car to my friends and colleagues.
- I rarely take chances by buying unfamiliar brands even if it means sacrificing variety.
- I would rather wait for others to try out a new brand than try it out myself.
- I would rather stick to well known companies while buying a car.
- I would rather stick with a brand I usually buy than try something I am not very sure of.
- If I like a brand, I rarely switch from it just to try something different.
- I feel proud to be seen buying my brand.
- If I find my brand is not giving me the quality I expect it to, then I switch to another brand.
- After switching from my favorite brand, I never go back to it.
- I am loyal to a brand that is being used in my home for the past many years.
- If my favored brand reduces my social acceptability then I switch to other brands.
- If my favored brand no longer offers me value for money then I will switch to another brand
- I will always buy a brand I can relate to.
- I will be loyal to a brand whose personality matches mine.
- The more the congruence between my personality and that of my favorite brand, the more loyal I will be to it.
- My brand reinforces my personality.
- I reinforce my brands personality in turn.
- I will keep buying the brand which makes me realize what I am.

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